

Essential Travel Checklist

If you're drowned under a pile of things to do, try the Essential Travel Checklist, available at the Apple app store

A-GPS

This is an abbreviation for assisted GPS and is used primarily in mobile phones to determine location with assistance from the network

It really doesn't matter where you're heading to, but getting your money's worth. Whether your destination is *God's own country*, or the *Land of the Rising Sun*, how could you be sure you're not taken for a *ride* by the taxi driver? How would you ever bargain as a true *desi* when all you know about China is fried rice and Jackie Chan?



Travel with Technology

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It's May. You're either on your way to an exciting destination, or, well, you're not. If you are, this article could help, if not, it'll help you plan the next holiday you take. Most of us are all too familiar with the usual hustle and bustle of travel – book tickets and hotel rooms online. We're not covering that here. Instead, we're looking at all the other stuff that's also important.

Look before you leap

Before you even think of booking your tickets, make sure you have all the information you'll need. Pause for a while and ponder over your requirements. You need portability – try to get all your

needs met with as little hardware as possible. Control your urge to carry *all* your prized possessions with you during your trip. You may carry a high-end camera if you want to, but if you're not going to showcase your pictures, then you can get more than your want from smartphones these days! Similarly, you may carry a studio grade laptop, despite a netbook, or tablet meeting all your requirements on the go. The best balance is being able to keep it, portable, light and easy to carry around yet giving you access to all possibilities.

Stay connected

Remember you're vacationing! That means no work. No heavy downloads. Technically, even GPRS should do. All your groundwork should be done

before you begin your journey. If you're in Shenzhen, you don't want to sift through Chinese web sites wondering how to get back to your hotel room! What would your condition be if you lost network coverage?

We suggest you take the mid way. For data connectivity and to take advantage of the superior app-driven ecosystem called iTunes, get a smartphone (could be a budget one that supports tethering) and an iPod Touch.

Get all the apps we recommend here onto your iPod Touch, so that you are not left stranded in the middle of the road, surrounded by souls that don't understand Hindi or English (or for that matter any regional Indian language).

You can use the iOS app on your iPod Touch and share data access via your